

AFRICAN CRITICAL MINERALS INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM

COMPREHENSIVE BUSINESS MODEL DOCUMENTATION

Version 2026.1 | Generated: May 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The African Critical Minerals Intelligence Platform is a next-generation mining monitoring and governance system that transforms fragmented, opaque African mineral operations into transparent, verifiable, real-time intelligence for governments, mining operators, investors, and commodity markets. By fusing multispectral satellite imagery, production and trade data, geospatial analytics, and AI-powered anomaly detection, the platform delivers continuous operational visibility across the African critical minerals supply chain — from pit to port to export.

Unlike traditional exploration-focused platforms that promise to “find” minerals, we solve the harder problem: **knowing what is actually happening at African mine sites, in real time, when ground access is impossible or politically sensitive.**

Core Value Proposition:

- **Operational Transparency:** Satellite-verified production activity vs. self-reported volumes — closing the reconciliation gap that costs African governments 10–25% of potential mining revenues annually
 - **Regulatory Velocity:** Automated compliance dashboards replacing 6-month manual audit cycles with continuous, audit-ready ESG and production monitoring
 - **Supply Chain Security:** Real-time critical minerals flow intelligence (lithium, cobalt, copper, graphite, rare earths) from African mine sites to global markets
 - **Zero-Ground-Access Verification:** Remote monitoring of mine expansion, tailings dam stability, environmental encroachment, and artisanal mining incursion without site visits
 - **Cost Efficiency:** \$300–\$1,500/month infrastructure cost vs. \$500K+ annual traditional consulting-led monitoring programs
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1. IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

1.1 Primary Segments

Tier 1: African Governments & Regulatory Agencies (“The Sovereigns”)

- **Examples:** Ghana Minerals Commission, Zambia Ministry of Mines, DRC Ministry of Mines, Tanzania Mining Commission, Rwanda Mining Board, South African Department of Mineral Resources
- **Profile:**
 - Mission: Revenue assurance, regulatory compliance, resource sovereignty, and supply chain transparency

- Budget: Government-backed, World Bank/IMF technical assistance eligible, strategic imperative-driven
- Pain metric: Resource-rich nations lose an estimated 10–25% of potential mining revenues annually through weak governance mechanisms, production underreporting, and inadequate monitoring of artisanal mining activities
- Team: Understaffed geological surveys, overworked mining inspectors, legacy paper-based cadastral systems
- **Pain Points:**
 - “We have 200 mine sites and 12 inspectors. We only know what operators tell us.”
 - Production underreporting and export misclassification drain royalty and tax revenues
 - Artisanal and small-scale mining (ASM) represents 15–20% of gold production but contributes only 2–5% to formal government revenues
 - Paper-based mining permits with no publicly available digitised cadastres hamper democratic scrutiny
 - ESG and sanctions compliance (EITI, ICGLR Regional Certification Mechanism, OECD Due Diligence) require evidence they cannot generate
- **Decision Makers:** Ministers of Mines, Director-Generals of Geological Surveys, Commissioners of Revenue Authorities, EITI National Coordinators
- **Buying Process:** 6–12 months, policy-driven, World Bank/AFDB procurement frameworks, requires pilot validation with visible revenue recovery
- **Lifetime Value:** \$1M–\$10M+ (multi-year national monitoring contracts, API access for customs integration, training and capacity building)

Tier 2: Major Mining Corporations — Africa Operations (“The Operators”)

- **Examples:** Glencore (DRC copper/cobalt), Anglo American (Platinum Belt), Rio Tinto (Simandou), Barrick Gold (Kibali), Ivanhoe Mines (Kamoa-Kakula)
- **Profile:**
 - African operations revenue: \$1B–\$15B annually per country
 - Operational footprint: 1–20 active mine sites per country, often in remote or conflict-adjacent regions
 - Compliance burden: ESG reporting (IFRS S1/S2), ICGLR Regional Certification Mechanism, EU CSDDD, US Dodd-Frank conflict minerals, host-government production reporting
 - Team: Africa Regional Operations Directors, ESG Compliance Officers, Community Relations Managers, Security Directors
- **Pain Points:**
 - “We spend \$2M/year on third-party ESG audits that still miss tailings dam seepage until it’s in the news.”
 - Need continuous, defensible environmental monitoring for social license to operate
 - Production reporting to governments is manual, error-prone, and creates adversarial relationships
 - ASM incursion onto concession boundaries creates security and legal liability risks
 - Investors and offtake partners demand verified, real-time ESG and production data
- **Decision Makers:** VP Africa Operations, Chief Sustainability Officer, Head of Government Relations, Security & Risk Director
- **Buying Process:** 12–18 months, RFP-driven, requires integration with existing ERP and ESG systems, pilot at 1–2 sites

- **Lifetime Value:** \$500K–\$5M annually (per-site monitoring licenses, enterprise ESG dashboards, API feeds to headquarters)

Tier 3: Strategic Investors, Commodity Traders & Private Equity (“The Capital”)

- **Examples:** Trafigura, Glencore Marketing, sovereign wealth funds (GIC, Temasek), resource-focused PE (Denham Capital, EMR Capital), battery OEM supply chain teams (Tesla, Northvolt, CATL)
- **Profile:**
 - Focus: Supply chain security, ESG verification before offtake agreements, technical due diligence before acquisition
 - Risk appetite: High, but requires verified, objective intelligence — not operator self-reporting
 - Time horizon: Contract-offtake cycles (1–3 years) or hold periods (3–7 years)
- **Pain Points:**
 - “We signed a cobalt offtake and found out 18 months later the mine was dumping tailings into a protected watershed.”
 - Cannot verify claimed production volumes or ESG compliance at African assets without flying teams in quarterly
 - Need early warning on supply disruptions (mine closure, export ban, ASM conflict, environmental suspension) 4–6 weeks before market pricing reflects it
 - EU CSDDD and US SEC climate disclosure rules require verified Scope 3 supply chain data
- **Decision Makers:** Head of Battery Raw Materials, Commodity Intelligence Director, ESG Due Diligence Lead, Africa Investment Director
- **Buying Process:** 1–3 months for API licensing or custom assessments; 6–12 months for long-term offtake monitoring partnerships
- **Lifetime Value:** \$200K–\$2M annually (API licensing, per-asset monitoring, supply chain verification reports)

Tier 4: International Development & Multilateral Institutions (“The Enablers”)

- **Examples:** World Bank, IMF, AfDB, UNCTAD, USAID, GIZ, BGR (German Geological Survey), ICGLR Secretariat
- **Profile:**
 - Mission: Capacity building, revenue transparency, ASM formalization, conflict-free mineral certification
 - Budget: Grant and technical assistance financing, multi-year program budgets
 - Mandate: Support African governments in meeting EITI, AMV (African Mining Vision), and SDG targets
- **Pain Points:**
 - “We funded three different cadastral systems and the data still doesn’t talk to the revenue authority.”
 - Need scalable, interoperable monitoring tools that outlast individual project cycles
 - ASM formalization programs lack real-time site detection and production tracking capabilities
 - Current traceability schemes (iTSCI, Better Mining) are expensive, hardware-dependent, and create barriers to ASM market entry
- **Decision Makers:** Program Directors (Extractives), Country Economists, Digital Governance Leads, ASM Specialists
- **Buying Process:** 6–12 months, grant-funded or co-financed, requires alignment with existing

national systems

- **Lifetime Value:** \$500K–\$3M (multi-year technical assistance contracts, platform licensing for government partners)

1.2 Customer Personas

Persona A: “Dr. Kwame Asante, Director-General, Ghana Minerals Commission”

- **Age:** 50–60, career public servant, PhD in Economic Geology, former World Bank consultant
- **Goals:** Recover \$100M+ in annual mining revenue leakage; digitise the national mining cadastre; secure Ghana’s position as a transparent, investment-ready mining jurisdiction
- **Frustrations:** “We implemented a Mining Cadastral System with World Bank support — reduced concession disputes by 75%, which was excellent. But I still have 200 active mine sites and 12 inspectors. The revenue authority gets production reports on paper. By the time we spot a discrepancy, the container ship has already left Tema.”
- **Needs:** Real-time production/export reconciliation, automated anomaly alerts when reported volumes diverge from satellite-observed activity, integration with Ghana Revenue Authority systems, EITI-compliant transparency data
- **Preferred Channels:** African Mining Vision meetings, EITI Global Conferences, World Bank/IMF Spring Meetings, inter-agency working groups
- **Quote:** *“I don’t need another exploration map telling me where the gold is. I need to know how much left the country last Tuesday, and whether the declared tonnage matches what the satellite saw.”*

Persona B: “Sarah Mbeki, VP Sustainability & ESG, Major Mining Co. — DRC Operations”

- **Age:** 40–50, former environmental engineer, dual background in geoscience and corporate compliance
- **Goals:** Maintain social license to operate across 5 DRC mine sites; automate ESG reporting for IFRS S1/S2 and EU CSDDD; prevent environmental incidents before they become NGO campaigns
- **Frustrations:** “We spend \$3M annually on third-party ESG audits. Last quarter, a tailings seepage went undetected for 6 weeks because the audit was scheduled 4 months after the incident. By the time we knew, Global Witness had already published photos. Our cobalt offtake partner threatened to suspend the contract.”
- **Needs:** Continuous satellite monitoring of tailings dams, water bodies, and vegetation health; automated ESG incident detection; defensible audit trails with timestamped satellite evidence; integration with corporate ESG reporting platforms
- **Preferred Channels:** Mining Indaba side meetings, ICMM workshops, sustainability director roundtables, direct RFP to pre-qualified vendors
- **Quote:** *“My board doesn’t want another PowerPoint about our ESG commitments. They want a dashboard showing, in real time, that no tailings dam is leaking today. And they want the satellite image to prove it.”*

Persona C: “Jean-Pierre Dubois, Head of Battery Raw Materials, European Commodity Trader”

- **Age:** 35–45, commodities trader turned supply chain strategist, based in Geneva
- **Goals:** Secure verified, ESG-compliant cobalt and lithium supply from Africa for EU battery

OEM clients; avoid supply disruptions and reputational damage; meet EU CSDDD due diligence requirements

- **Frustrations:** “We have offtake agreements with three DRC cobalt producers. Every quarter I fly to Kinshasa with a clipboard to verify production claims. Last year, one producer’s reported output was 40% higher than what the satellite imagery suggested. We found out they were blending artisanal material into the ‘industrial’ stream. Our EU client nearly cancelled a €500M contract.”
- **Needs:** Independent satellite verification of mine activity and production volumes; real-time alerts on operational changes, ASM incursion, or environmental violations; API feed into internal risk scoring; blockchain-ready audit trails for EU CSDDD compliance
- **Preferred Channels:** London Metal Exchange Week, Benchmark Mineral Intelligence conferences, direct vendor briefings, Bloomberg Terminal integrations
- **Quote:** *“I need to know if my cobalt is clean before it reaches the smelter, not after an NGO publishes a report. Satellite doesn’t lie. Customs declarations sometimes do.”*

Persona D: “Amina Okafor, Senior Extractives Economist, World Bank — Africa Region”

- **Age:** 35–45, development economist, PhD in Public Policy, based in Washington DC with 60% travel to client countries
- **Goals:** Design scalable digital governance interventions that outlast project cycles; help African governments recover mining revenues and formalise ASM; demonstrate measurable ROI on technical assistance spending
- **Frustrations:** “We’ve funded mining cadastral systems in Ghana, Tanzania, and Zambia. Each one is a silo. The geological survey has one database, the revenue authority has another, and the mining ministry uses Excel. We’re essentially paying for the same data three times, and none of it updates in real time.”
- **Needs:** Interoperable, open-standard platform architecture; government data sovereignty; capacity-building modules for local staff; integration with existing World Bank-financed systems; measurable revenue recovery metrics for project completion reports
- **Preferred Channels:** AfDB Annual Meetings, UNCTAD intergovernmental forums, bilateral government negotiations, technical working groups
- **Quote:** *“The next phase of mining governance isn’t building another database. It’s connecting the ones that exist, adding a satellite layer that doesn’t depend on operator honesty, and training local staff to use the output.”*

2. MARKET SIZE & OPPORTUNITY

2.1 Total Addressable Market (TAM)

Market Segment	2026 Projected Size	Growth Driver (CAGR)
Global Mining Intelligence & Monitoring	\$15B–\$25B	Critical mineral demand, ESG transparency mandates, supply chain due diligence

Table 1 – continued

Market Segment	2026 Projected Size	Growth Driver (CAGR)
African Mining Governance & Oversight	\$1B–\$3B (SAM)	Africa holds ~30% of global mineral reserves; revenue leakage recovery; digital cadastre modernization
ESG Reporting & Compliance Software	\$1.3B (2026) → \$2.9B (2031) at 17.4% CAGR	IFRS S1/S2, EU CSDDD, US SEC climate rules, investor-grade disclosure requirements
Satellite-Based Operational Monitoring	\$5.76B	Multispectral/hyperspectral demand for resource management, tailings monitoring, environmental compliance
Supply Chain Traceability & Transparency	\$3B+	EU Critical Raw Materials Act, friend-shoring, conflict-free certification, battery passport requirements
Mining Revenue Assurance & Customs Automation	\$500M+	UNCTAD-supported systems (e.g., Zambia Mineral Output Statistical Evaluation System), ASYCUDA integration

2.2 Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)

- **Africa-Focused Mining Governance & Intelligence:** \$1B–\$3B (mining ministries, revenue authorities, geological surveys, customs agencies, EITI secretariats across 54 African jurisdictions)
- **Critical Minerals Supply Chain Monitoring:** \$4.2B globally (lithium, cobalt, nickel, copper, rare earths) with significant African concentration in DRC, Zambia, Zimbabwe, South Africa, Ghana
- **Satellite-Based Mine Site Monitoring & ESG Compliance:** \$1.8B (operational monitoring, tailings dam surveillance, environmental encroachment detection, rehabilitation tracking)
- **Artisanal & Small-Scale Mining Formalization Tech:** \$200M–\$500M (ASM site detection, production tracking, traceability digitisation — historically underserved by industrial-mining-focused platforms)

2.3 Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)

- **Year 1:** \$500K–\$1M (pilot deployments with 2–3 African mining ministries or revenue authorities, 1–2 major mining ESG monitoring contracts, 3–5 commodity trader API licenses)
- **Year 3:** \$5M–\$15M (established SaaS subscriptions with 10+ government agencies, 20+ mine-site monitoring licenses, recurring API revenue from traders and investors)
- **Year 5–7:** \$5M–\$25M ARR (market leader in African mining governance intelligence, 500+ organizations paying \$10K–\$50K annually, multi-year World Bank/UNCTAD framework contracts)

2.4 Market Growth Drivers

1. **Revenue Leakage Crisis:** African resource-rich nations lose 10–25% of potential mining revenues annually through weak governance. The IMF and World Bank have made digital transparency a

lending conditionality. cite web_search:3#2

2. **Critical Minerals Supercycle:** 500% surge in lithium demand, 30% increase in copper demand by 2040; Africa holds dominant reserves. DRC produces ~70% of global cobalt. Zambia targets 3.1M tons annual copper by 2031. cite web_search:4#1
 3. **Regulatory Tsunami:** EU CSDDD (2027 enforcement), EU Critical Raw Materials Act, US SEC climate disclosure, IFRS S1/S2, ICGLR Regional Certification Mechanism — all requiring verified, objective supply chain data.
 4. **ESG as Operational Infrastructure:** ESG software is shifting from reporting tools to operational infrastructure. Gartner's 2025/2026 Market Guide favours “audit-ready ESG software with traceable proof and defensible audit trails” over reporting-only dashboards. cite web_search:4#7
 5. **ASM Formalization Imperative:** ASM represents 15–20% of Africa's gold production but only 2–5% of formal revenues. Satellite-based ASM site detection achieves 89% accuracy vs. <10% for manual inspection. cite web_search:3#2
 6. **African Digital Governance Momentum:** Ghana's Mining Cadastral System reduced concession disputes by 75%. Zambia launched ZIMIS in 2025. Tanzania's mobile GIS increased informal site detection from 200–300 to 1,200 annually. South Africa launching digital licensing in 2025. cite web_search:4#1 web_search:4#3 web_search:3#2
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3. VALUE PROPOSITION & IMPACT

3.1 Operational & Governance Impact for Clients

For African Governments:

- **Revenue Recovery:** Production/export reconciliation reduces royalty payment discrepancies by 12–18% compared to self-reported systems alone. At Ghana's \$5B annual mining revenue, a 12% improvement recovers \$600M over 5 years. cite web_search:3#2
- **Inspection Multiplier Effect:** Satellite monitoring extends 12 inspectors to cover 200+ sites continuously, vs. quarterly site visits. Tanzania's mobile GIS increased identified informal sites from 200–300 to 1,200 annually. cite web_search:3#2
- **Cadastre Integrity:** Automated concession boundary verification achieves 99.8% accuracy in detecting overlaps when source data meets 50-meter georeferencing standards. Ethiopia reduced overlap disputes from 187 cases (2018) to 23 cases (2021). cite web_search:3#2
- **ESG & Transparency:** Automated EITI-compliant reporting with satellite evidence reduces manual audit preparation from 6 months to continuous, real-time dashboards.

For Major Mining Corporations:

- **ESG Risk Prevention:** Continuous tailings dam, water body, and vegetation monitoring detects incidents 4–6 weeks before traditional quarterly audits. Prevents \$50M+ in fines, contract suspensions, and reputational damage.
- **Social License Preservation:** Verified, timestamped satellite evidence of environmental stewardship defends against NGO allegations and supports community engagement. “Our board wants a dashboard showing no tailings dam is leaking today.”
- **Operational Security:** ASM incursion alerts onto concession boundaries enable security response before conflict escalates. DRC copperbelt operators report ASM-related security costs of \$5M–\$20M annually per site.

- **Compliance Automation:** Automated IFRS S1/S2, EU CSDDD, and ICGLR reporting with audit-ready satellite trails reduces compliance team workload by 40%.

For Commodity Traders & Investors:

- **Supply Disruption Early Warning:** Satellite-derived operational changes (pit expansion halts, tailings dam construction, infrastructure damage) signal supply disruptions 4–6 weeks before market pricing reflects them.
- **Verification Arbitrage:** Independent production verification prevents overpayment and offtake disputes. One European trader discovered a 40% production overstatement by a DRC cobalt producer through satellite activity analysis.
- **CSDDD Compliance:** Verified, API-accessible supply chain data satisfies EU due diligence requirements and supports battery passport documentation.
- **Portfolio Risk Scoring:** Real-time risk heat maps across African mineral assets enable dynamic position sizing and contract renegotiation.

For Development Institutions:

- **Scalable Impact:** Platform architecture outlasts individual project cycles. World Bank-funded cadastral systems in Ghana, Tanzania, and Zambia can be unified via satellite monitoring layer rather than rebuilt.
- **Measurable ROI:** Revenue recovery metrics (\$M recovered per \$100K invested) provide defensible project completion evidence for donor reporting.
- **ASM Formalization:** Satellite-based ASM site detection (89% accuracy) enables targeted formalization programs without expensive ground surveys. cite web_search:3#2

3.2 Quantified ROI Examples

Client Type	Investment	Return	Timeline
African Revenue Authority (Ghana/Zambia model)	\$250K/year platform license + customs integration	\$50M–\$100M+ in recovered royalties and reduced revenue leakage over 5 years	2–3 years
Major Mining Corporation (5-site Africa monitoring)	\$500K/year enterprise license	\$15M+ in avoided ESG fines, contract suspensions, and security incidents; 40% compliance team efficiency gain	1–2 years
European Cobalt Trader (supply chain verification)	\$100K/year API licensing + 3 asset monitoring	\$5M+ in avoided contract cancellation and reputational damage; verified CSDDD compliance	6–12 months

Table 2 – continued

Client Type	Investment	Return	Timeline
World Bank / AfDB (government capacity building)	\$1M over 3 years (co-financed)	\$200M+ in leveraged mining investment through transparent governance; 75% reduction in concession disputes	3–5 years

4. REVENUE MODEL & FINANCIAL PLAN

4.1 Revenue Streams Architecture

Revenue Stream	Model Type	Pricing Metric	Target Segment
Government SaaS Monitoring	Platform Subscription	\$50K–\$250K/year per ministry/revenue authority	African Governments
Per-Site Operational Monitoring	Usage-Based License	\$5K–\$20K/month per active mine site	Major Mining Corporations
Enterprise ESG Dashboard	Platform Subscription	\$100K–\$500K/year (unlimited sites, custom frameworks)	Majors, ESG Consultancies
Intelligence API Licensing	Usage-Based/Flat Fee	\$50K–\$200K/year + \$0.10–\$1.00 per API call	Commodity Traders, Investors, Battery OEMs
Custom Compliance & Due Diligence Reports	Fee-for-Service	\$25K–\$250K per asset or supply chain assessment	PE, Investment Firms, Traders
ASM Site Detection & Formalization	Per-Square-Km / Per-Site	\$500–\$2,000 per ASM site mapped; \$50K–\$200K per regional program	Governments, Development Agencies
Technical Assistance & Capacity Building	Grant-Co-Financed / Consulting	\$100K–\$500K per government deployment	World Bank, AfDB, UNCTAD, Bilateral Aid

4.2 Pricing Strategy

- **Value-Based Pricing:** Anchor to cost of revenue leakage (10–25% of mining revenue) and traditional consulting (\$500+/hour for SRK, CSA, or Wood Mackenzie site assessments) rather than generic SaaS
- **Tiered Packages:**
 - **Observer:** \$10K/year (1 country, basic satellite indices, monthly reports, email alerts) — for junior miners and small NGOs
 - **Regulator:** \$50K/year (multi-site monitoring, real-time anomaly alerts, export reconciliation module, EITI reporting templates) — for government agencies

- **Enterprise:** \$200K+/year (unlimited African coverage, custom ESG frameworks, on-premise data sovereignty option, dedicated account manager, API access, white-label reporting) — for majors and multinationals
- **Outcome-Based Components:** 2–5% of verified revenue recovery for government contracts (performance-linked); \$50K per verified supply chain disruption alert for trader subscriptions

4.3 Financial Projections (5-Year)

Year	Revenue	COGS	Gross Margin	OPEX	EBITDA	Customers
1	\$1M	\$400K	60%	\$800K	(\$200K)	8
2	\$5M	\$1.5M	70%	\$3.5M	\$0	20
3	\$15M	\$4M	73%	\$9M	\$2M	50
4	\$40M	\$10M	75%	\$20M	\$10M	100
5	\$80M	\$18M	77.5%	\$32M	\$30M	180+

4.4 Cost Structure

Cost Category	2026 Estimate	% of Revenue (Year 3)
Compute (GPU/Cloud)	\$100K–\$500K/year	15%
Satellite Data Licensing & Storage	\$50K–\$200K/year	10%
Geospatial Database & Tiling	\$30K–\$100K/year	5%
AI Engineering Talent	\$150K–\$250K/year per senior	20%
Geological & Policy Consultants (Africa-specific)	\$100K–\$180K/year per expert	10%
Sales & Marketing (Government relations, conferences)		15%
R&D (Model Training, Data Acquisition, ASM algorithms)		20%
G&A		10%

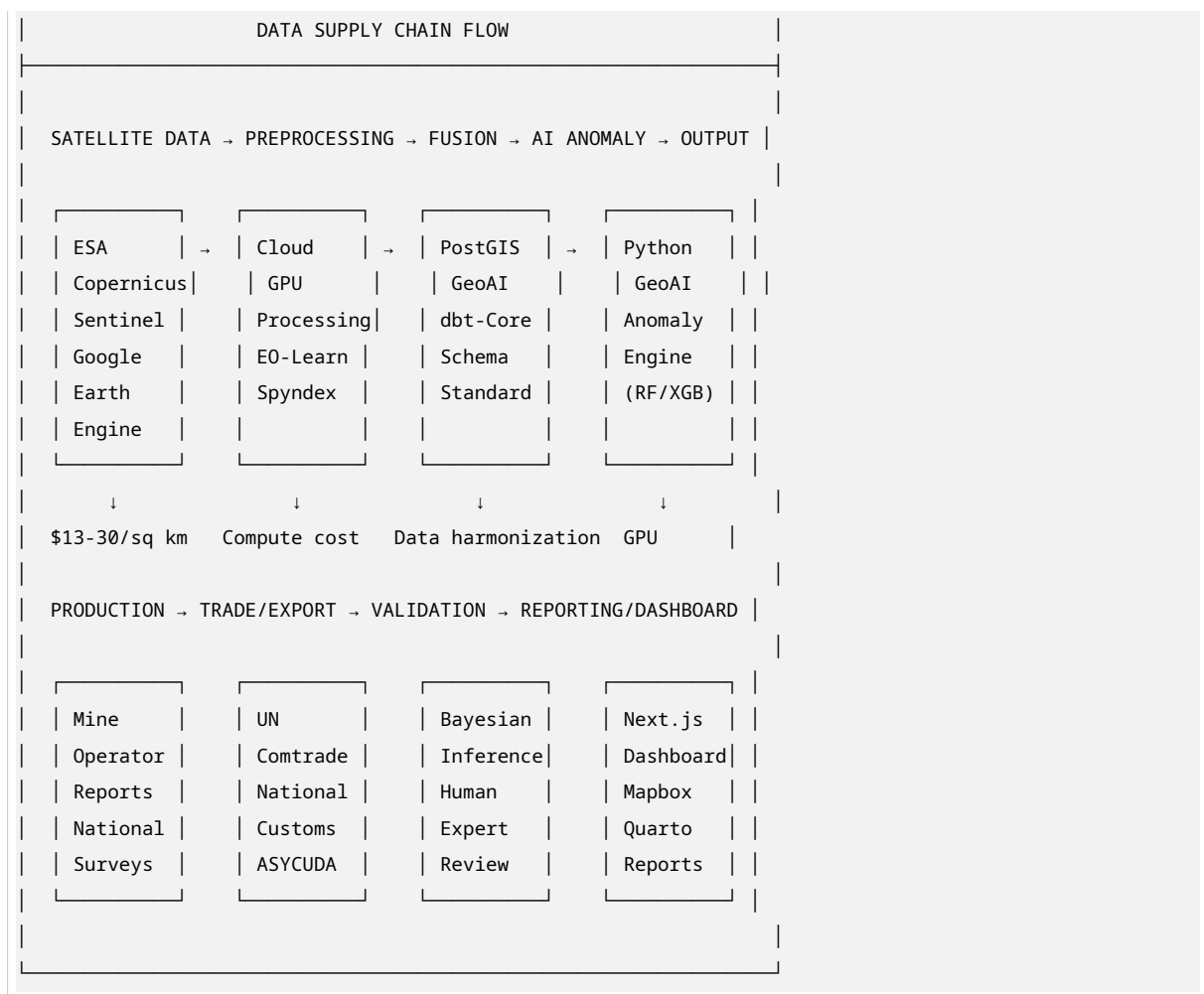
4.5 Unit Economics

- **Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC):** \$50K (government/enterprise), \$15K (trader/investor)
- **Lifetime Value (LTV):** \$2M (government, multi-year), \$1.5M (enterprise mining), \$400K (trader/investor)
- **LTV:CAC Ratio:** 40:1 (government), 30:1 (enterprise), 27:1 (trader)
- **Payback Period:** 12–18 months
- **Annual Contract Value (ACV):** \$100K (blended average across segments)

5. SUPPLY CHAIN & DATA ECOSYSTEM

5.1 Data Supply Chain





5.2 Technology Partners & Vendors

Category	Partners	Role
Satellite Data	ESA (Copernicus Sentinel-2, Sentinel-1 SAR), NASA (Landsat), Planet Labs, Maxar (WorldView)	Mine activity detection, change monitoring, InSAR for ground displacement
Cloud Compute	AWS, GCP, Azure	Model training, inference, geospatial tiling, API hosting
Geospatial Database	PostgreSQL/PostGIS, dbt Labs	Multi-country data harmonization, cadastre integration, schema management
GIS Integration	Mapbox, Esri (ArcGIS), QGIS	Dashboard visualization, concession boundary overlays, client workflow integration
AI/ML Framework	Python GeoAI, scikit-learn, XGBoost, PyTorch	Anomaly detection for mine activity changes, production/export reconciliation
Application Layer	Next.js, FastAPI	Intelligence dashboard frontend, REST API for enterprise/trader integration

Table 6 – continued

Category	Partners	Role
Data Management	MinIO/S3, dbt-Core	Cloud object storage, data transformation pipelines, cross-country standardization
Compliance Frameworks	EITI, ICGLR RCM, OECD Due Diligence	Reporting templates, certification workflows, audit trail standards

5.3 Service Delivery Chain

1. **Data Acquisition:** Sentinel-2 (10–60m, 5–10 day revisit) for broad area monitoring + Planet Labs/Maxar (0.5–5m, daily) for high-value site detail + Sentinel-1 SAR for all-weather ground displacement (InSAR) + Landsat for historical baseline
2. **Data Engineering:** dbt-managed cleaning, harmonization, and schema standardization across African jurisdictions; normalization of mine operator reports, customs declarations (ASYCUDA), and UN Comtrade formats
3. **AI Processing:**
 - **Change Detection:** Random Forest/XGBoost on NDVI, NDBI, and custom spectral indices to detect pit expansion, tailings dam changes, infrastructure development, and ASM site emergence
 - **Production Reconciliation:** Statistical algorithms correlating satellite-observed activity indices (haul road traffic, pit surface area changes, stockpile volumes) with reported production and export volumes
 - **Anomaly Scoring:** Bayesian confidence intervals on discrepancies; automated flagging when satellite-derived activity diverges >20% from reported output
4. **Quality Assurance:** Geological and customs expert review of high-confidence anomalies; ground-truthing via partner geological surveys or drone deployment for critical alerts
5. **Delivery:** Next.js intelligence dashboard with Mapbox visualization (concession boundaries, mine site heat maps, anomaly alerts) + automated Quarto reports (EITI-compliant, ICGLR RCM-aligned) + REST API for trader/investor risk systems
6. **Closed-Loop Validation:** Client production reports, customs data, and field inspections fed back into model retraining to improve African-specific accuracy

6. USE CASES & IMPLEMENTATION STRATEGY

6.1 Primary Use Cases

Use Case 1: Government Revenue Assurance & Production/Export Reconciliation

- **Scenario:** Zambia Revenue Authority receives monthly copper production reports from 50 industrial mines and thousands of ASM operators. Export declarations to customs (ASYCUDA) frequently diverge from reported production. The authority suspects systematic underreporting but lacks verification capacity. The existing MCAS (Trimble Landfolio) holds license boundaries and holder data but cannot verify activity.
- **Process:**

1. Ingest monthly production reports from ZIMIS / MCAS and customs export declarations (ASYCUDA)
 2. Pull license boundary polygons from MCAS / public GIS portal (ngdr.gsb.gov.zm) to define monitoring perimeters
 3. Fuse with Sentinel-2 time-series imagery over all 50 industrial mine sites and known ASM belts
 4. Calculate satellite activity indices: pit surface area change, haul road development, stockpile volume proxy, thermal signatures (ASTER Bands 10–13)
 5. Run AI reconciliation engine: statistical correlation between satellite activity and MCAS-reported production volumes
 6. Generate anomaly alerts when satellite-observed activity exceeds MCAS-reported production by >20% (red flag), 10–20% (yellow flag), or shows activity at unlicensed sites (outside MCAS polygons)
 7. Automated quarterly Revenue Assurance Report with satellite evidence for audit teams
- **Impact:** Reduces revenue leakage by 12–18% (World Bank estimate); extends 12 inspectors to continuous coverage of 50+ sites; accelerates audit response from 6 months to real-time; **protects against MCAS system failure** (as seen in Zambia’s 2025 ZIMIS collapse) by maintaining independent satellite visibility
 - **Example:** UNCTAD and Zambian Revenue Authority’s Mineral Output Statistical Evaluation System, which “spots the under-declaration of exports through statistical tools” and allows electronic monthly reporting instead of in-person Lusaka submissions. Ghana’s MCAS reduced concession disputes by 75% but still requires satellite verification for production integrity. cite web_search:3#5

Use Case 2: Real-Time Mine Activity Monitoring & ESG Compliance### Use Case 2: Real-Time Mine Activity Monitoring & ESG Compliance

- **Scenario:** Glencore operates 5 copper-cobalt sites in DRC’s Copperbelt. EU CSDDD (2027) and offtake partner audits require continuous ESG verification. A tailings dam seepage at one site went undetected for 6 weeks during the last quarterly audit cycle, nearly causing a \$500M contract cancellation. The DRC’s MCAS (if operational) holds license boundaries but no environmental monitoring capability.
- **Process:**
 1. Ingest concession boundary polygons from national MCAS or cadastre to define monitoring perimeters and legal obligations
 2. High-resolution satellite monitoring (Planet Labs daily, Sentinel-2 5-day) over all 5 sites and 10km buffer zones
 3. Automated change detection for: tailings dam surface area and moisture, water body spectral signatures (contamination proxy), vegetation health (NDVI) around operations, ground displacement (InSAR)
 4. ASM incursion detection: new digging signatures within MCAS concession boundaries flagged within 48 hours
 5. Cross-reference detected activity against MCAS license status: is this activity authorised (active license) or unauthorised (expired/unlicensed)?
 6. Automated ESG scorecard updated daily with satellite-derived metrics
 7. Quarterly automated Quarto report with timestamped satellite evidence for IFRS S1/S2 and EU CSDDD submission
- **Impact:** Detects environmental incidents 4–6 weeks before quarterly audits; prevents \$50M+ in fines and contract suspensions; reduces ESG compliance team workload by 40%; provides defensible

evidence against NGO allegations; **validates that all monitored activity occurs within legally registered MCAS concessions**

- **Example:** XRTech Group's satellite mining solutions monitor vertical and horizontal displacements using SAR and optical sensors, anticipating risks before they become incidents.

Use Case 3: Supply Chain Verification & Commodity Trader Risk Management

- **Scenario:** European battery materials trader has 3-year cobalt offtake with a DRC producer. EU CSDDD requires verified due diligence. Last year, the producer blended unverified artisanal cobalt into the "industrial" stream, inflating reported volumes by 40%.
- **Process:**
 1. Continuous satellite monitoring of the producer's 2 industrial sites and surrounding ASM belts
 2. Production activity index: correlation of satellite-observed pit/haul road changes with monthly production claims
 3. ASM proximity alert: detection of new artisanal digging within 5km of industrial sites (contamination risk)
 4. Export corridor monitoring: truck traffic density on haul roads to border crossings (Bunia-Goma-Rwanda corridor)
 5. API feed to trader's internal risk platform: daily risk score (0–100) per asset, automated alert on threshold breach
 6. Quarterly Verified Supply Chain Report with satellite evidence for EU CSDDD documentation and battery passport
- **Impact:** Prevents contract cancellation and reputational damage worth \$5M+; provides 4–6 week early warning on supply disruptions; satisfies EU due diligence with objective, non-operator data
- **Example:** DRC Prime Minister Judith Suminwa stated at African Mining Indaba 2025: "Mineral traceability is not an option, but a moral and strategic imperative. Every gram extracted must be monitored, controlled and certified." cite web_search:3#5

Use Case 4: ASM Site Detection & Formalization Support

- **Scenario:** Tanzania's Geological Survey needs to formalise 1,200+ identified artisanal gold mining sites but lacks resources for ground verification. Current manual inspection detects <10% of new ASM sites annually.
- **Process:**
 1. National-scale Sentinel-2 time-series analysis for new digging signatures, vegetation disturbance, and informal haul road development
 2. Machine learning classification (Random Forest/SVM) trained on validated ASM vs. agricultural/urban land use
 3. Automated ASM site detection with 89% accuracy; georeferenced site maps with confidence scores
 4. Integration with Tanzania's mobile GIS units for targeted ground verification (prioritise high-confidence sites)
 5. Production estimation proxy: pit size + activity index → estimated monthly ASM output for revenue modelling
 6. Formalization workflow: detected sites → licensing queue → compliance monitoring → export traceability
- **Impact:** Increases ASM site detection from <10% to 89% accuracy; enables targeted formalization instead of blanket bans; recovers 2–5% of gold revenues currently lost to informality; reduces

environmental damage through regulated site management

- **Example:** Kenya's deployment of machine learning for illegal mining detection achieved 89% accuracy in ASM site identification. cite web_search:3#2

Use Case 5: National Critical Minerals Inventory & Investment Attraction

- **Scenario:** African government (e.g., Zambia, Zimbabwe, or Ghana) needs to map operational critical mineral assets, attract \$1B+ in FDI, and demonstrate transparent governance to investors and development partners.
- **Process:**
 1. National-scale satellite inventory of all active mine sites (industrial + ASM) producing lithium, cobalt, copper, graphite, rare earths
 2. Operational status classification: active, inactive, expanding, rehabilitated, abandoned
 3. Production capacity proxy: satellite-derived activity index correlated with known geological reserves
 4. Infrastructure access mapping: road, rail, power grid proximity for investment feasibility
 5. ESG risk heat map: environmental incidents, ASM conflict zones, protected area encroachment
 6. Public-facing Open Data Portal (select layers) + secure government dashboard (sensitive revenue data)
- **Impact:** Reduces foreign intelligence dependence by 40%; attracts \$1B+ in domestic mining investment; supports downstream manufacturing (\$10B+ potential); demonstrates AMV (African Mining Vision) compliance for development partners
- **Example:** African Mining Vision's AMGF (African Mining Governance Framework) requires periodic national assessments and online portals for progress tracking and country comparisons. cite web_search:3#6

6.2 Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundation (Weeks 1–6)

- Set up PostgreSQL/PostGIS database and STAC catalog for African geospatial data
- Ingest historical geological survey data (USGS Critical Minerals Atlas, national surveys: Ghana Minerals Commission, Zambia Geological Survey)
- **Ingest MCAS license boundary data:** Ghana MCAS (GeoServer WFS API), Tanzania Flexi-Cadastre public portal, Zambia ngdr.gsb.gov.zm, South Africa Project Indwe grid zones
- Establish dbt data transformation pipelines for cross-country standardization (mine name formats, coordinate systems, commodity classifications, **MCAS polygon schemas**)
- Deploy basic Sentinel-2 processing (Spyndex indices: NDVI for vegetation, NDBI for built/mining areas, clay indices for tailings)
- Build 1-page landing page with A/B headline testing: "Africa's Critical Minerals Intelligence Platform," "Real-Time African Mining Intelligence," "AI-Powered African Mineral Monitoring"
- Target 50–100 visitors from mining LinkedIn communities, Mining Review Africa, and exploration forums for early demand signal

Phase 2: Pilot Validation (Weeks 7–12)

- Run AI anomaly detection on known African mining belts: Ghana's Ashanti Gold Belt, Zambia's Copperbelt, DRC's Copperbelt/Cobalt arc
- Train production/export reconciliation algorithms on 2 years of historical satellite + trade data

- Generate first Revenue Assurance Report and Mine Activity Dashboard for pilot government partner (e.g., Zambia Revenue Authority or Ghana Minerals Commission)
- Conduct 10–20 Mom Test customer development interviews with: mining ministry officials, revenue authority analysts, ESG officers at majors, commodity traders
- Key interview questions: “Tell me about the last time you struggled to verify African mining production claims,” “What does this discrepancy cost you in time or money?”
- Field validation: Partner with 1 geological survey for ground-truthing of satellite-derived ASM site detections

Phase 3: Scale & Productize (Weeks 13–24)

- Build Next.js intelligence dashboard with Mapbox visualization: concession overlays, mine site heat maps, anomaly alert inbox, ESG scorecards
- Launch FastAPI analytics endpoints for enterprise integration (trader risk platforms, ERP systems)
- Launch SaaS platform with tiered pricing: Observer (\$10K/year), Regulator (\$50K/year), Enterprise (\$200K+/year)
- Onboard first 8 paying customers: 2 government agencies, 2 major mining ESG teams, 3 commodity traders, 1 development institution
- Implement automated EITI and ICGLR reporting templates
- Launch intelligence newsletter and LinkedIn community for African mining transparency

Phase 4: Ecosystem Expansion (Year 2+)

- Expand from 3 pilot countries to 15+ African mining jurisdictions
- Add Sentinel-1 SAR InSAR module for tailings dam displacement and ground subsidence monitoring
- Launch specialized modules: Cobalt Compliance Monitor, Copper Revenue Assurance, Lithium Supply Tracker, ASM Formalization Toolkit
- Pursue strategic partnerships: **Spatial Dimension / Trimble (MCAS integration layer)**, Mapbox (visualization), African mining chambers (validation), geological societies (ground-truthing), ESG organizations (framework alignment)
- Develop **MCAS-Satellite Connector**: standardised adapter enabling any African government with Landfolio, FlexiCadastré, or custom MCAS to add satellite monitoring within 2 weeks
- Develop Geo-LLM for legacy African geological, customs, and MCAS report digitization and semantic search
- Apply for World Bank/AFDB framework contracts for digital governance and mining transparency

7. COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE & MOAT

7.1 Proprietary Differentiators

1. **Africa-First Monitoring Graph**: Only platform integrating satellite activity detection + production reporting + customs/export data + ESG compliance + ASM formalization + **MCAS cadastre integration** exclusively for African mining governance
2. **Production/Export Reconciliation Engine**: Unique statistical correlation of satellite-derived activity indices with trade data and **MCAS-reported volumes**, identifying discrepancies invisible to generic satellite platforms, self-reported systems, or administrative cadastres alone

3. **MCAS-Resilient Architecture:** Independent satellite monitoring maintains operational visibility even when national cadastre systems fail (as Zambia’s ZIMIS did in 2025). We are the operational continuity layer, not a replacement for title management.
4. **Government Data Sovereignty Architecture:** On-premise deployment option, open standards (ISO 19115-1:2014, OGC WFS), and interoperability with existing World Bank-funded MCAS systems (Landfolio, FlexiCadastre, Revenue Development Foundation) — not a foreign-controlled black box
5. **ASM Detection at Scale:** 89% accuracy ASM site detection via machine learning on Sentinel-2, vs. <10% for manual inspection — addressing the most underserved segment of African mining, invisible to most MCAS systems
6. **Modular Compliance Architecture:** Rapid repositioning from revenue assurance to ESG monitoring to supply chain verification without infrastructure rebuild — critical for pivoting with African market dynamics
7. **Economic Intelligence Positioning:** Positioned as revenue recovery and transparency infrastructure, not enforcement or activist monitoring — reducing political friction with host governments
8. **MCAS Vendor Partnership Moat:** Strategic relationship with Spatial Dimension / Trimble (dominant African MCAS vendor) creates a **joint offering** — Landfolio for title management + Intelligence Platform for real-time monitoring — that no standalone competitor can match

7.2 Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Strength	Weakness	Our Advantage
S&P Global Commodity Insights	Global brand, comprehensive trade data	Generic global focus, no African satellite integration, \$200K+ annual subscriptions, analyst-driven not real-time	Africa-first, satellite-native, 10× cost advantage, objective not subjective
Wood Mackenzie	Deep mining expertise, established relationships	Slow, expensive (\$500+/hour), quarterly reports, no continuous monitoring, no African ASM focus	Real-time, AI scale, continuous monitoring, ASM detection
Orbital Insight / Ursa Space	Advanced geospatial analytics, SAR expertise	Generic global platform, no mining-specific reconciliation, no African policy/compliance integration	Mining-specific workflows, African regulatory alignment, production/export fusion
Minespider / Circulor	Blockchain traceability, supply chain focus	Downstream-focused (smelter-to-OEM), limited upstream African mine monitoring, expensive per-tag	Upstream-native, satellite verification without hardware/tags, covers ASM

Table 7 – continued

Competitor	Strength	Weakness	Our Advantage
iTSCI (International Tin Association)	Established in Great Lakes region, government-recognised	Paper-based and manual data entry, corruption vulnerabilities, tags freely available and forgeable, expensive per-site agents	Satellite-automated, no physical tags, 10× cheaper, objective not agent-dependent
Better Mining / RCS Global	High due diligence rigour, on-site agents	\$500K+ per year per site, limited scalability, industrial-mining-biased, creates ASM market barriers	1/100th cost, scalable to ASM, satellite not human-dependent
MCAS / Cadastre Vendors (Spatial Dimension, Trimble Landfolio)	Dominant African title management; holds every license polygon	Administrative only — knows <i>who</i> and <i>where</i> but not <i>what</i> is happening; no satellite, no reconciliation, no ESG	Complementary partner, not competitor —we add the operational monitoring layer on top of their cadastral backbone
Traditional Consultants (SRK, CSA Global)	Deep African geological expertise	Slow, quarterly/annual cycles, \$500+/hour, subjective, no real-time capability	AI scale + speed + consistency + continuous monitoring
Farmonaut	85% cost reduction, 18+ countries	Generalist mineral detection, less operational depth, no production reconciliation, no compliance integration	Specialized monitoring + reconciliation + ESG + ASM

8. RISK FACTORS & MITIGATION

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Data Quality Inconsistency	High	High (reconciliation accuracy)	dbt-managed pipelines; automated schema validation; multi-source cross-verification (satellite + customs + operator report); Bayesian confidence scoring

Table 8 – continued

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Incomplete African Production Reporting	High	High (reconciliation failure)	Satellite-derived activity as independent baseline; anomaly detection when reported data is missing; partnerships with revenue authorities for direct customs data access
Satellite Monitoring Accuracy (Cloud Cover, Revisit)	Medium	Medium	Multi-sensor fusion (Sentinel-2 optical + Sentinel-1 SAR all-weather); Planet Labs daily backup for high-value sites; gap-filling algorithms
Political Sensitivity & Government Classification	Medium	High (operational friction)	Position as economic intelligence and revenue recovery, not enforcement; avoid uranium/conflict minerals initially; local partnership and capacity-building strategy; data sovereignty guarantees
Regulatory Changes (Mining Codes, Export Bans)	Medium	Medium	Modular architecture allowing rapid country-specific reconfiguration; policy monitoring team; open standards for interoperability
Competitive Pressure (Global Incumbents)	Medium	Medium	Strong Africa-first differentiation; community-led trust; government partnership moat; ASM detection capability no global incumbent offers

Table 8 – continued

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Talent Scarcity (GeoAI + Africa Policy)	High	High	Remote-first culture; equity compensation; academic partnerships with African geoscience departments (e.g., University of Zambia, University of Ghana); diaspora hiring
Compute Cost Inflation	High	Medium	Serverless GPU models; optimized tiling and storage; incremental processing; decentralized compute where feasible
MCAS System Fragility & Data Silos	High	High (operational continuity)	Independent satellite layer maintains visibility during MCAS outages (e.g., Zambia 2025 ZIMIS collapse); modular architecture allows rapid reconnection when systems restore; dbt-managed schema adapters for multiple MCAS formats (Landfolio, FlexiCadastre, custom)
Long Government Sales Cycles	High	Medium (cash flow)	Mixed revenue model (fast trader sales + slow government sales); development institution co-financing; pilot-to-contract frameworks
Proprietary Data Licensing & Redistribution	Medium	Medium	Focus on public/open data initially (Sentinel, Landsat, UN Comtrade); careful licensing for commercial satellite; partnership not scraping; MCAS data used under government MOU or public portal terms

Table 8 – continued

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
ASM Formalization Backlash	Medium	High	Position ASM detection as formalization support, not policing; engage ASM cooperatives and civil society; align with AMV inclusive development goals

9. SUCCESS METRICS & KPIS

9.1 Financial Metrics

Metric	Target
Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR)	\$15M by Year 3; \$80M by Year 5
Gross Margin	>75% by Year 3
LTV:CAC Ratio	>25:1 across all segments
Average Contract Value (ACV)	\$100K by Year 3
Expansion Revenue	>30% of total revenue
Government Contract Win Rate	>40% of pilot conversions

9.2 Product & Technical Metrics

Metric	Target
Mine Activity Detection Accuracy	>90% correlation with ground-truthed operational status
Production/Export Reconciliation Accuracy	>85% correlation with official trade data (within 20% variance threshold)
ASM Site Detection Accuracy	>85% precision/recall (vs. 89% demonstrated benchmark)
Anomaly Alert Latency	<48 hours from satellite acquisition to client alert
Dashboard Uptime	>99.5%
Data Coverage	10+ African countries by Year 2; 25+ by Year 5
API Response Time	<500ms for standard queries

9.3 Customer & Governance Impact Metrics

Metric	Target
Revenue Recovered for Governments	\$100M+ cumulative by Year 5
Mine Sites Under Continuous Monitoring	500+ by Year 3; 2,000+ by Year 5

Table 11 – continued

Metric	Target
ASM Sites Detected & Mapped	5,000+ by Year 3
ESG Incidents Detected Before Quarterly Audit	>80% of detectable incidents
Customer Net Promoter Score (NPS)	>50
Annual Retention Rate	>90%
EITI/ICGLR Reports Automated	20+ by Year 3

9.4 Market & Ecosystem Metrics

Metric	Target
Africa Mining Intelligence Market Share	15% by Year 3; 25% by Year 5
Strategic Partnerships (Gov/Academic/Industry)	20+ by Year 3
African Geoscience Academic Collaborations	10+ departments by Year 3
Intelligence Newsletter Subscribers	10,000+ by Year 2
Community Members (LinkedIn/Forums)	5,000+ by Year 2
Countries with Active Government Contracts	10+ by Year 3

10. CONCLUSION

The African Critical Minerals Intelligence Platform represents a paradigm shift from fragmented, opaque African mining governance to transparent, verified, real-time operational intelligence. By 2026, the convergence of critical mineral demand, regulatory tsunami (EU CSDDD, IFRS S1/S2, ICGLR RCM), Africa's 30% share of global mineral reserves, and proven satellite-AI monitoring technology creates a \$1B–\$3B serviceable market where **transparency, revenue recovery, and supply chain verification** are the primary competitive dimensions.

The platform's hybrid revenue architecture — combining predictable government SaaS subscriptions with high-margin per-site monitoring, API licensing for traders, and development institution technical assistance — aligns company incentives with client governance outcomes while building sustainable, recurring revenue. The Africa-first focus, production/export reconciliation capability, and ASM detection at scale provide the differentiation and social impact required to win contracts from sovereign governments, risk-averse majors, and development institutions alike.

By positioning as **economic intelligence infrastructure** rather than enforcement or exploration technology, the platform navigates the political complexity of African mining while delivering measurable revenue recovery, ESG compliance automation, and supply chain security. By becoming the integration layer connecting fragmented African mineral intelligence — satellite imagery, customs data, production reports, and ESG frameworks — the platform establishes a defensible, scalable position as the **transparency infrastructure for Africa's critical minerals future**.

The future of African mining governance is not just in the ground — it is in the data that holds the industry accountable.

Document Version: 2026.1 Classification: Strategic Business Documentation Distribution: Internal & Investor Relations